VS Code - getting your python running

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IDE (Integrated Development Editor) options for running Python

- VSCode - the obvious choice, many of you are running it already
  - can convert notebooks, *.ipynb*, to pdf's, similar to knitting

Prerequisites: Having installed the *methods3_2026* environment (see Preamble)

How to check: from a terminal (Linux/Mac) or Anaconda Powershell Prompt (Windows) run `conda activate methods3_2026`

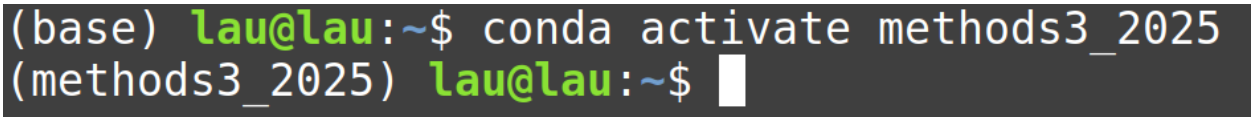
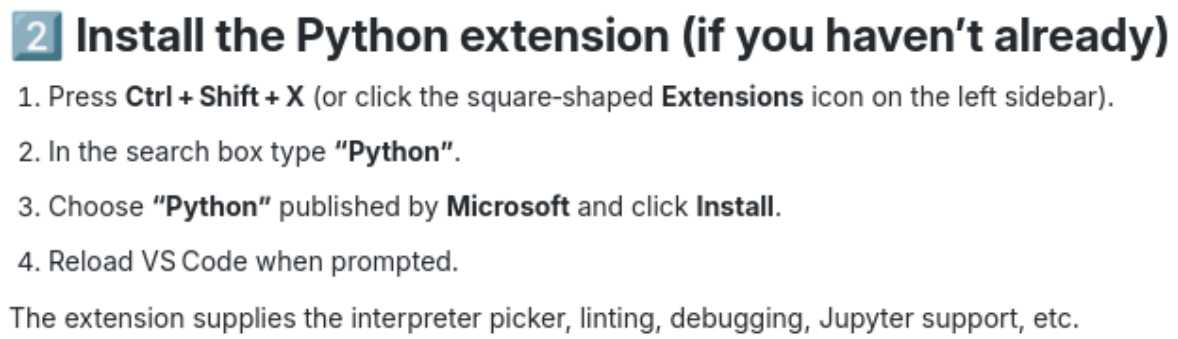


Figure 1: Activate conda env, (here shown with 2025)

VSCode

Here are some tested suggestions from Lumo (a GAI):



Also install the Jupyter extension

(An error that many had was that VS Code requested the package *ipykernel*, but couldn't install it even when clicking install. If so, open a terminal or anaconda prompt and write:)

```
conda activate methods3_2026
conda install ipykernel
```

4️⃣ Tell VS Code which Conda interpreter to use

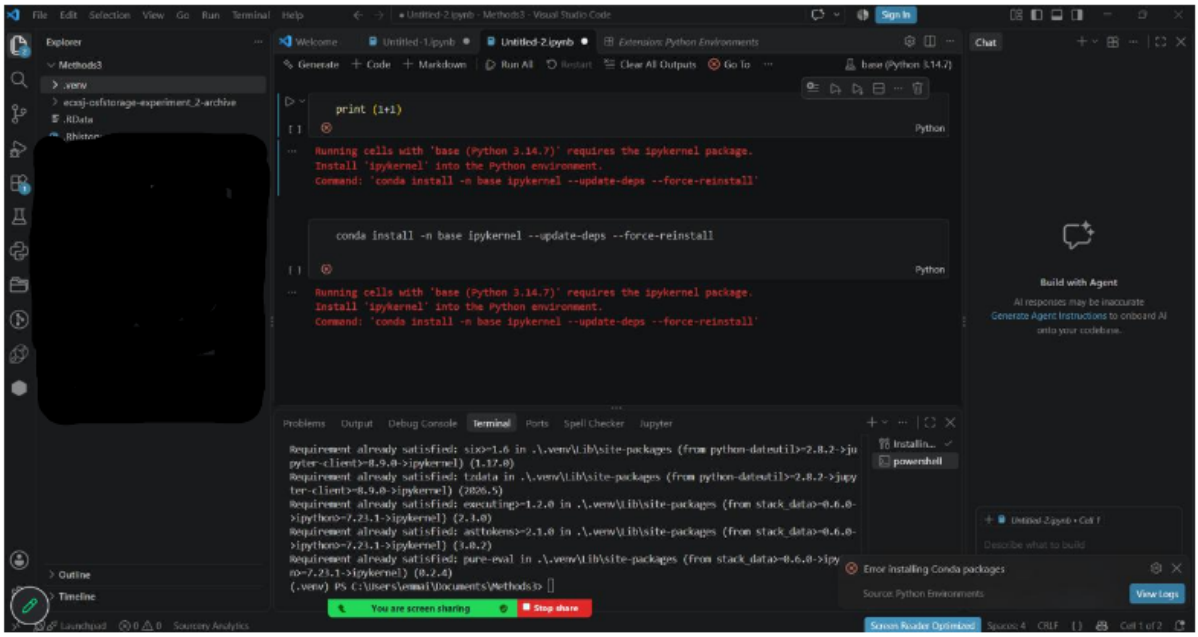
1. **Open a folder or workspace** in VS Code (`File → Open Folder…`).
2. Press **Ctrl + Shift + P** (or ⇧⌘P) to open the **Command Palette**.
3. Type **"Python: Select Interpreter"** and hit **Enter**.
4. You'll see a list that includes entries like:

```
Conda (myenv) • C:\Users\<you>\miniconda3\envs\myenv\python.exe
```

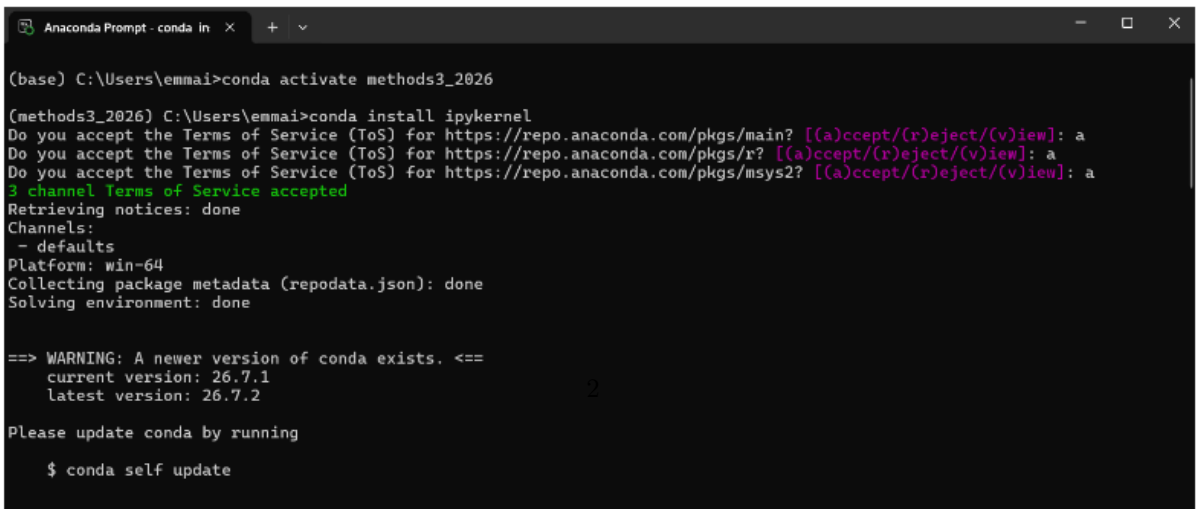
5. Click the entry that corresponds to the environment you want.

VS Code writes the selection to a hidden settings file inside the workspace:

Figure 2: Find conda env



Error installing so we download it manually in anaconda



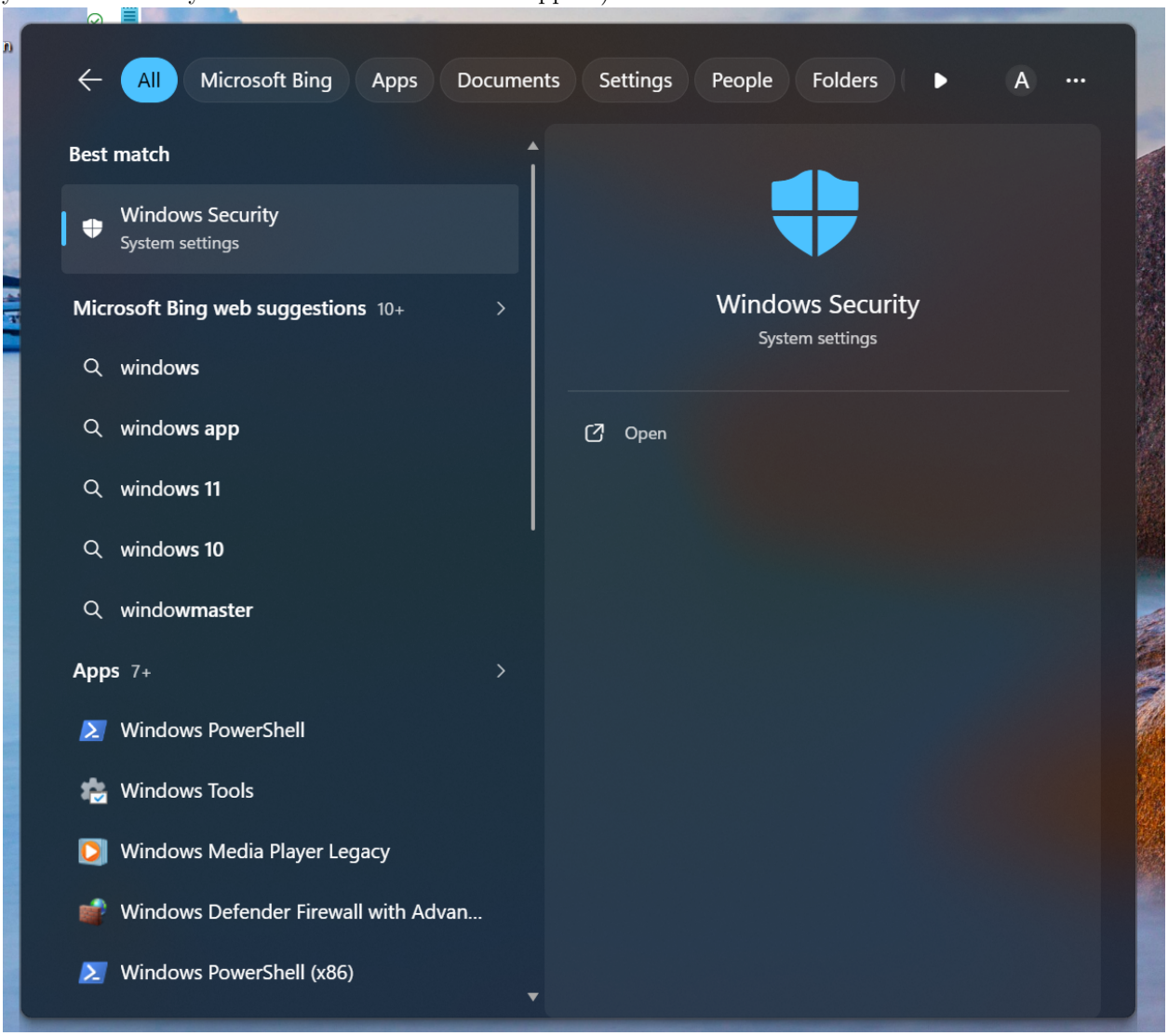
Here with a screenshot from Emma's computer

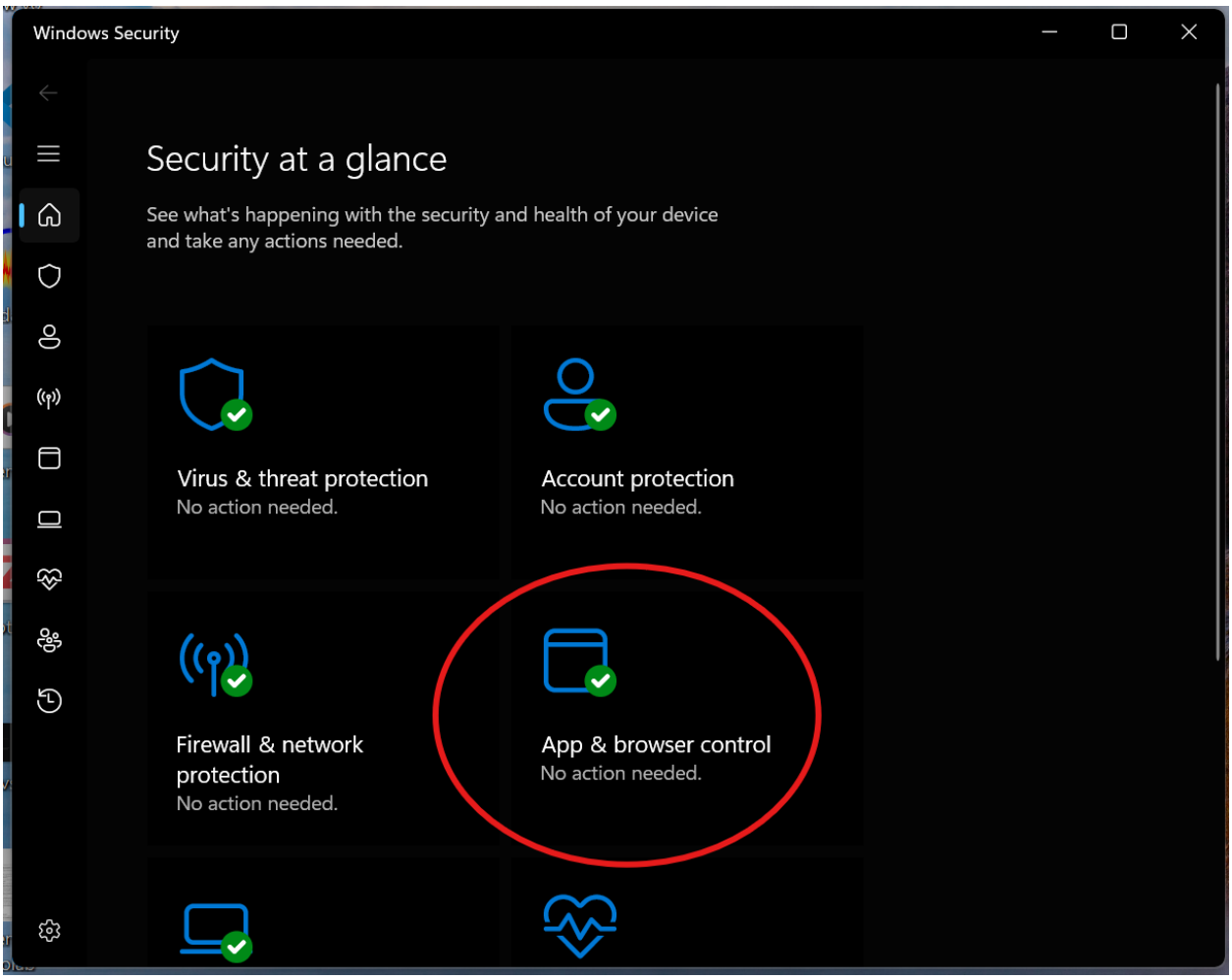
Exporting to html

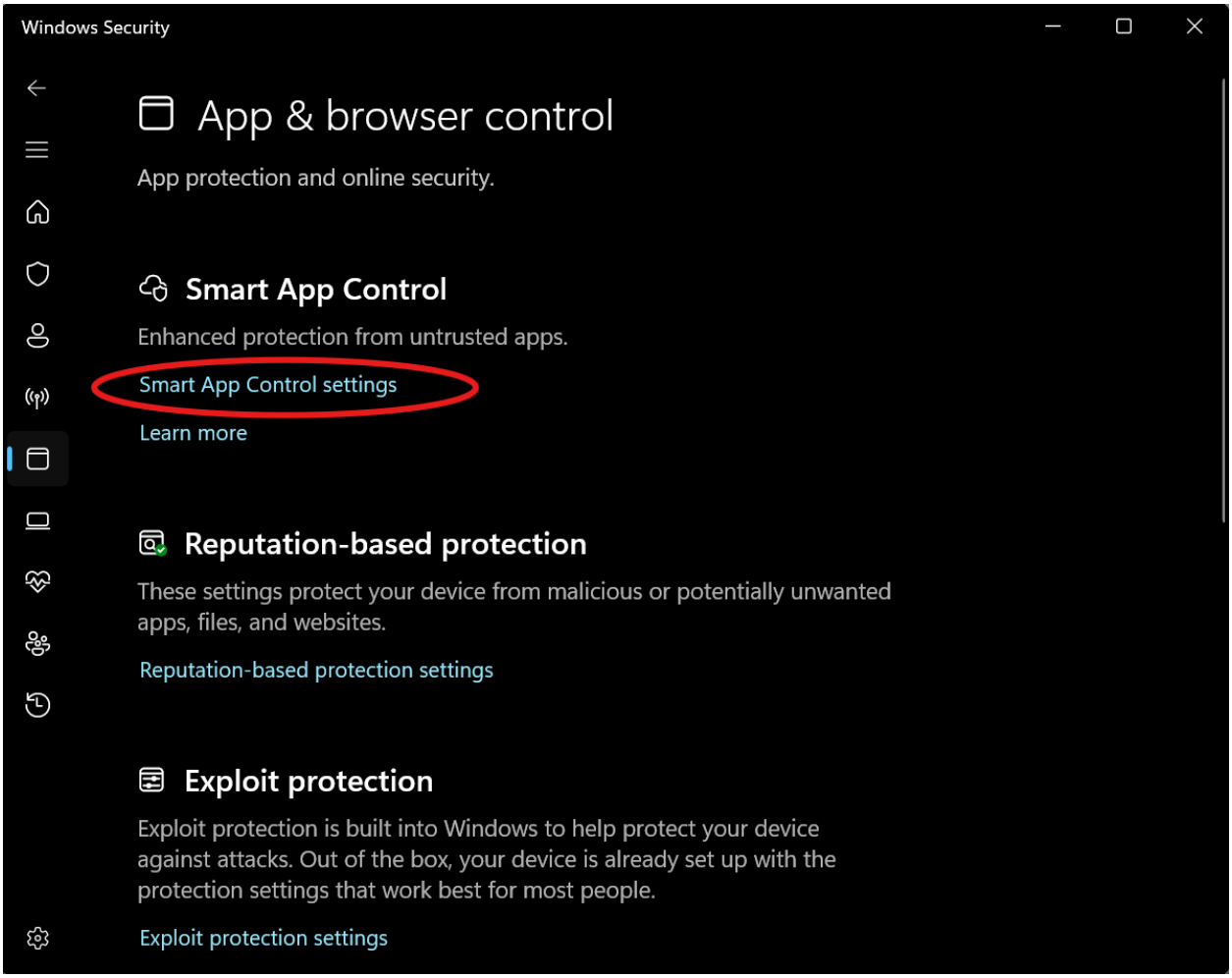
Please check these different methods link for creating html that you can then convert to pdf's from, e.g., a browser. **Remember pdf's are a requirement for assignments and exams**

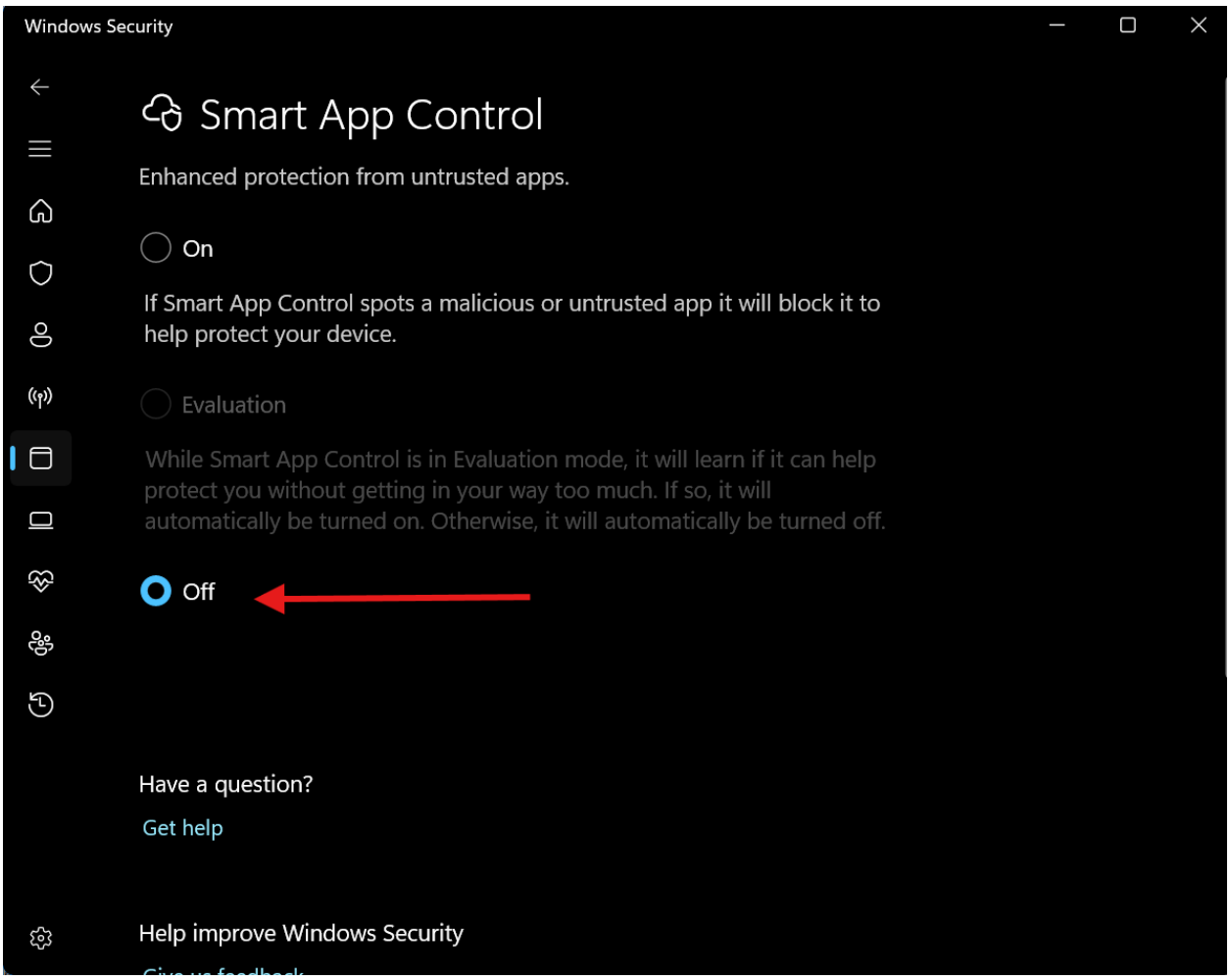
Further troubleshooting

Windows protecting you from yourself (thanks, Daniel) Windows may try to protect you from yourself by not allowing you to install or run things that you have installed in VSCode
If you want to turn this off completely, then you can follow what Daniel did here. (You have to choose yourself whether you want to have this "Smart"App on)




Windows Security
Security at a glance
See what's happening with the security and health of your device and take any actions needed.
Virus & threat protection
No action needed.
Account protection
No action needed.
Firewall & network protection
No action needed.
App & browser control
No action needed.


Windows Security
App & browser control
App protection and online security.
Smart App Control
Enhanced protection from untrusted apps.
Smart App Control settings
Learn more
Reputation-based protection
These settings protect your device from malicious or potentially unwanted apps, files, and websites.
Reputation-based protection settings
Exploit protection
Exploit protection is built into Windows to help protect your device against attacks. Out of the box, your device is already set up with the protection settings that work best for most people.
Exploit protection settings


Windows Security
Smart App Control
Enhanced protection from untrusted apps.
On
If Smart App Control spots a malicious or untrusted app it will block it to help protect your device.
Evaluation
While Smart App Control is in Evaluation mode, it will learn if it can help protect you without getting in your way too much. If so, it will automatically be turned on. Otherwise, it will automatically be turned off.
Off
Have a question?
Get help
Help improve Windows Security